

Compare and Contrast Characters and Events

USA Grade 5 ELA
CCSS RL.5.3

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING TARGET

I can compare characters and events using specific details.

KEY STRATEGY + WORKED EXAMPLE

Use the same comparison categories for both subjects and explain why similarities or differences matter.

During the storm, Ana calmly organized flashlights and checked each room. Dev paced by the window but quickly helped when Ana gave him a task.

A. TRY TOGETHER - USE THE STRATEGY

1. Name the skill in today's learning target.
2. Underline the words in the model or source that matter most.
3. State the first step of the strategy.
4. Explain what a complete answer must include.

B. CORE PRACTICE - SHOW YOUR WORK

5. State one important fact explicitly given in the source.

6. Determine the comparison of Ana and Dev.

7. Select the strongest supporting detail.

8. Explain how that detail supports your answer.

9. Identify a second relevant detail.

10. Distinguish one reasonable inference from one unsupported idea.

11. Explain how the author's word or detail choices develop meaning.

12. Write a concise objective summary of the source.

C. INDEPENDENT FLUENCY - CALCULATE AND CHECK

13. State the comparison of Ana and Dev in your own words.

14. Quote or precisely paraphrase one piece of evidence.

15. Embed that evidence in a complete sentence.

16. Explain the logical link between evidence and answer.

17. Write one question answered directly by the source.

18. Write one question requiring an inference.

19. Answer the inference question with evidence.

20. Revise one response using precise academic vocabulary.

Compare and Contrast Characters and Events

USA Grade 5 ELA
CCSS RL.5.3

Name: _____

Date: _____

D. APPLY THE SKILL

21. Complete a full comparison of Ana and Dev response using at least two details from the source.

22. Evaluate which evidence is strongest for the comparison of Ana and Dev and justify your choice.

23. Create a new example that uses the same skill, then explain it.

E. REASON, CHECK AND CORRECT

24. Explain why this strategy works and when it is useful.

25. Describe a likely mistake and show how to correct it.

EXIT TICKET + CHALLENGE

26. Apply compare and contrast characters and events to a new example and explain your evidence or rule.

Challenge: Create a rigorous example of compare and contrast characters and events, complete it, and justify every decision.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - SHOW WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND

Use your own words so your teacher can see what you understand and what to practise next.

27. Explain one strategy you used today.

28. Check one answer in a different way.

29. Circle one: I understand it | I need more practice | I need help

30. The easiest part was: _____

31. The most difficult part was: _____

Why was it difficult? _____

32. My next practice step is: _____

TEACHER COPY - ANSWERS AND SUPPORT

ANSWER KEY

- A. 1) Skill correctly named. 2) Relevant words identified. 3-4) Answers vary; require the stated strategy and complete-response criteria.
- B. 5) Both respond to the storm. 6) Ana is calm/decisive; Dev is anxious but cooperative. 7) Ana organizes supplies. 8) It shows leadership. 9) Dev paces then helps. 10) Saying both ignore the problem is unsupported. 11) The storm reveals different responses. 12) Ana leads calmly, while Dev overcomes anxiety and helps.
- C. 13-20) Answers vary. Require an accurate comparison of Ana and Dev, relevant evidence or rule, clear explanation, and correct conventions.
- D. 21) Complete response with two relevant details. 22) Strongest evidence should be specific and directly support the comparison of Ana and Dev: Ana organizes calmly while Dev changes from anxious to helpful. 23) New example varies but must transfer the same skill.
- E. 24-25) Answers vary. Require precise reasoning and a corrected example supported by the text or rule.
- EXIT. 26) Teacher checks independent transfer, evidence/rule, explanation, and conventions.
- Challenge: Answers vary. Check that the student's example follows every condition and that the reasoning is mathematically correct.
- F. 27-28) Answers vary. Look for a clear strategy and a valid second check. 29-32) Use the reflection to identify confidence, difficulty and the next teaching step.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students may list facts separately. Compare both characters within the same category and explain significance.

TEACHER CHECK

- ☐ Uses an appropriate Grade 5 ELA strategy.
- ☐ Shows or explains thinking clearly.
- ☐ Checks a response using evidence, a rule, or a second method.
- ☐ Identifies a specific difficulty and useful next practice step.

PARENT / TEACHER TIP

Ask the child to explain how they know, not only state an answer. Have them point to the text evidence or language rule, then revise one response aloud.

NEXT STEP

Revisit the item the child marked difficult. Model one example, solve one together, then ask the child to complete one independently and explain the strategy.